

ATTACKS ON SCHOOL STUDENTS, TEACHERS, AND OTHER EDUCATION PERSONNEL

During the 2022-2023 reporting period, GCPEA identified at least six attacks on school students, teachers, and other education personnel. In addition, *BBC* and other media sources citing the MoES reported that teachers in Russian-controlled areas of Ukraine have been tortured because they refused to teach a Russian curriculum.⁴⁴

In 2022, GCEPA identified at least six reported attacks on education personnel.⁴⁵ Attacks involved the abduction or detention of educators who reportedly resisted the adoption of Russian curriculum. For example:

- In late March and early April 2022, four school principals were abducted after refusing to change their schools' curricula in Melitopol city, Zaporizhzhia region, according to local media sources and a human rights group.⁴⁶
- As reported in late September 2022, a head teacher in the village of Ivanivka, Kherson region, was detained for 19 days, due to her refusal to adopt a Russian curriculum. According to international media outlet *BBC*, she was beaten while in detention.⁴⁷

GCPEA did not identify any attacks on school students, teachers, and other education personnel in 2023.

MILITARY USE OF SCHOOLS AND UNIVERSITIES

GCPEA identified at least 67 reports of the military use of schools and universities during the 2022-2023 reporting period. This marked a significant increase compared to previous years in which GCPEA identified only sporadic incidents.⁴⁸ GCPEA identified reports of armed forces from both sides of the conflict using schools and universities for military purposes,⁴⁹ although more reports identified Russian forces and affiliated armed groups as the perpetrator. In several cases, rival forces subsequently targeted the school or university being used, according to media outlets and human rights organizations.⁵⁰

In 2022, GCPEA identified at least 60 incidents of military use of schools and universities.⁵¹ Separately, the UN reported the use of 23 schools for military purposes that year, with Russian forces and affiliated armed groups perpetrating the majority of cases.⁵² Since it was unclear how many of these cases overlapped with reports that GCPEA collected, they were not included in the total number of military use incidents, to avoid double counting. A media outlet reported that, in Zaporizhzhia region, schools were partially occupied while students continued learning in the buildings.⁵³ Examples of military use of educational facilities included:

- Human Rights Watch and international media outlets reported that from early March until March 29, 2022, Russian forces used both a lyceum and kindergarten as a military base and hospital in Bohdanivka village, Kyiv region.⁵⁴
- Between February 24 and early March, Ukrainian Territorial Defense Force members used School No. 11, located nearby a kindergarten, in Izium city, Kharkiv region, as a base until Russians troops advanced on the city in early March 2022, according to interviews conducted by Human Rights Watch.⁵⁵

- Human Rights Watch reported that Russian forces used a school in Yahidne village, Chernihiv region, as a military base and detention center for 28 days in March and April 2022, holding more than 350 villagers in the basement, including at least 70 children. Ten older people died there during that time due to sickness or the poor conditions.⁵⁶
- In late April 2022, School No. 12, which served about 600 students, was used as a base, in Izium city, Kharkiv region. *The New York Times* reported that, around April 30, opposing forces targeted the school, killing approximately 200 soldiers stationed there.⁵⁷
- On May 21, 2022, a Russian airstrike damaged a university in Bakhmut city, Donetsk region, which was being used as a base by Ukrainian forces, as reported by Amnesty International.⁵⁸
- On May 27, 2022, Russian forces seized Dmytro Motornyi Tavria State Agrotechnological University and Bohdan Khmelnytsky Melitopol State Pedagogical University, in Melitopol city, Zaporizhzhia region, as reported by Scholars at Risk.⁵⁹
- In early September 2022, a school in Orlianske village, Zaporizhzhia region, was reportedly used as a military base on one floor, with military equipment stored in the yard, while school instruction continued on the second floor.⁶⁰
- Human Rights Watch reported that, between March and early September 2022, Russian forces used School No. 10 as a base, positioning military vehicles outside, in Izium city, Kharkiv region. Upon leaving the school, Russian forces reportedly looted it.⁶¹

GCPEA identified seven incidents of military use of schools or universities in 2023.⁶² Separately, the UN verified the military use of two schools.⁶³ Since the UN count may have overlapped with the reports identified by GCPEA, it was not included in the total, to avoid double counting. For example:

- Around January 30, 2023, a kindergarten in Tavrichesky town, near Skadovsky city, Kherson region, was used as a military hospital, according to local media.⁶⁴
- Around March 18, 2023, a school in Polohy city, Zaporizhzhia region, was reportedly used as a military field hospital, according to local media outlets.⁶⁵
- Around March 22, 2023, a kindergarten located in Vesele village, near Melitopol city, Zaporizhzhia region, was used as a military hospital, according to local media outlets.⁶⁶
- Around April 12, 2023, at least two educational institutions in Skadovsk city, Kherson region, were reportedly used as military bases while students attended classes, according to local media outlets.⁶⁷

ATTACKS ON HIGHER EDUCATION

For the 2022-2023 reporting period, GCPEA identified at least 39 incidents of attacks on higher education in Ukraine, the majority of which were attacks on higher education facilities while the remainder were attacks on students and staff. These incidents took place primarily in Kharkiv and Donetsk regions. Attacks on higher education increased significantly in 2022 and 2023 as compared to the previous reporting period, during which GCPEA did not identify any reports of attacks on higher education.⁶⁸

In 2022, GCPEA identified at least 34 reported incidents of attacks on higher education, which included two

attacks on higher education students and personnel.⁶⁹ Separately, the MoES reported that, as of December 24, 2022, the “property and premises” of 95 research or higher education institutions had been damaged.⁷⁰ Specifically in Kharkiv, 21 out of the 24 higher education institutions had been damaged or destroyed as of July 13, 2022, according to local media citing the MoES.⁷¹ These numbers are not included in the total number of incidents to avoid double counting and because it was unclear whether all the damage met GCPEA’s criteria of attacks on education. Examples of attacks on higher education facilities in 2022 included:

- On March 2, 2022, a Russian missile strike destroyed the Faculty of Economics at V.N. Karazin Kharkiv National University, in Kharkiv city and region, according to Scholars at Risk.⁷²
- On March 3, 2022, *PBS* reported that shelling damaged a dormitory and stadium at the University of the State Fiscal Service of Ukraine in Irpin city, Kyiv region.⁷³
- On July 6, 2022, a Russian missile strike hit the H.S. Skovoroda Kharkiv National Pedagogical University in Kharkiv city and region, reportedly killing a campus security guard and destroying several buildings on the campus, including the main building and the science library, according to Scholars at Risk and a local media outlet.⁷⁴
- On both August 17 and 19, 2022, Petro Mohyla Black Sea National University in Mykolaiv city and region was damaged by rockets fired by Russian forces, according to Scholars at Risk and media sources.⁷⁵
- *PBS* reported that, around September 19, 2022, the Bakhmut Medical College campus was shelled and partially damaged, in Bakhmut city, Donetsk region.⁷⁶
- Amnesty International and local media outlets reported that, on October 10, 2022, Russian forces damaged a building of the Kyiv National Shevchenko University during missile strikes on Kyiv city and region.⁷⁷
- On November 1, 2022, shelling in Mykolaiv city and region reportedly damaged the Mykolaiv Polytechnic Vocational College.⁷⁸

GCPEA identified two attacks on higher education staff in 2022:

- On June 4, 2022, Russian forces detained the dean of the Agronomy Faculty at Kherson State Agrarian and Economic University for two days, in Kherson city and region, as reported by Scholars at Risk.⁷⁹
- Scholars at Risk and media outlets reported that, around June 14, 2022, Russian forces detained the vice-rector of Kherson State University for a week before releasing him, in Kherson city and region.⁸⁰

In 2023, GCPEA identified five attacks on higher education, all of which were attacks on facilities.⁸¹ For instance:

- On January 8, 2023, two college dormitories were reportedly damaged by a missile strike in Kramatorsk city, Donetsk region, according to *Reuters* and the *Associated Press*.⁸²
- On February 5, 2023, a missile strike in Kharkiv city and region reportedly damaged the Beketov National University of Urban Economy building and injured a campus security guard.⁸³
- On October 12, 2023, shelling in Kherson city and region damaged a building at Kherson State University, according to local media outlets.⁸⁴

YEMEN

At least 55 attacks on schools and higher education facilities occurred during the 2022-2023 reporting period, many involving the use of explosive weapons, including airstrikes, shelling, and the emplacement of improvised explosive devices. Around 100 educational facilities were also used for military purposes. In addition, GCPEA identified reports of child recruitment and sexual violence at, or on the way to or from, educational institutions.

CONTEXT

Conflict continued in Yemen during the 2022-2023 reporting period, despite a six months-long truce. Houthi forces (also known as Ansar Allah) controlled much of the north and west of Yemen, including Sana’a; the Internationally Recognized Government of Yemen (IRG), supported by the Saudi- and United Arab Emirates-led Coalition (the Coalition), controlled parts of the south and much of the east; and the Southern Transitional Council (STC), an Emirati-backed group, controlled much of the rest of the south of the country.¹ In April 2022, IRG President Abd-Rabbu Mansour Hadi resigned and transferred power to a Presidential Leadership Council, which was made up of influential leaders from across Yemen who were opposed to the Houthis, as reported by Amnesty International, International Crisis Group, and media outlets.² Fighting escalated in early 2022;³ however, in April of that year, Houthi forces and the IRG agreed to a UN-mediated truce that included the cessation of military activities.⁴ The two-month truce was extended twice and ended in October 2022, although it largely endured in practice through the end of the reporting period.⁵ Fighting, and violations against civilians, including children, decreased during the six-month truce;⁶ however, political violence and human rights abuses persisted, according to the Armed Conflict Location & Event Data Project (ACLED) and a local human rights organization.⁷ In December 2023, the parties to the conflict agreed to implement a ceasefire and take steps toward resuming the peace process led by the UN.

In January 2022, the Coalition conducted three airstrikes that killed at least 80 civilians, including three children, as well as damaging civilian buildings, according to Human Rights Watch.⁸ Houthi forces conducted ground strikes across Yemen which resulted in civilian casualties and forced displacement during the reporting period;⁹ in July 2022, the non-state armed group reportedly shelled a neighborhood in Taizz city, killing one child and injuring eleven.¹⁰ Save the Children reported that the highest number of weekly child casualties over a two-year period in Yemen occurred in July 2022;¹¹ that year, landmines and unexploded ordnance were responsible for more than half of all child casualties.¹² In addition, state forces and non-state armed groups recruited or used 105 children in 2022, according to the UN.¹³

During the 2022-2023 reporting period, Yemen continued to experience an acute humanitarian crisis, with 21.6 million people in need of aid, including 11.1 million children.¹⁴ However, movement restrictions inhibited access to humanitarian support, disproportionately affecting women.¹⁵ In 2023, 4.5 million people were inter-

nally displaced, according to the UN.¹⁶ The economy further contracted in 2022 and 2023, and drought and floods compounded the humanitarian crisis.¹⁷

Conflict and natural disasters continued to impact education during the 2022-2023 reporting period. Around 2.7 million children were out of school in 2022 and 2023, around half of whom were girls.¹⁸ Between 2015 and 2022, 2,783 schools were damaged or not used for educational purposes, and around 368 others were affected by floods in 2022 alone, further hindering access to education.¹⁹ In addition, more than 155,000 teachers continued to work without receiving salary payments in 2022 and 2023.²⁰

ATTACKS ON SCHOOLS

During the 2022-2023 reporting period, GCPEA identified at least 47 reported attacks on schools in Yemen. Attacks included airstrikes, shelling, the use of other explosive weapons, raids, and crossfire. This represents a similar number of attacks on schools as compared to the previous reporting period, when GCPEA collected 20 and 28 reports of such attacks in 2021 and 2020, respectively.²¹

In 2022, GCPEA collected at least 21 reports of attacks on schools.²² Separately, the UN verified seven attacks on schools, students, or teachers.²³ In addition, a human rights organization reported 106 attacks on schools and incidents of military use of educational facilities, primarily perpetrated by the Houthis, followed by the IRG and the Coalition.²⁴ However, the UN and rights organization-reported incidents were not included in the total for this attack category, since it was unclear how many incidents were attacks on schools, rather than attacks on protected persons or military use. Examples of incidents collected by GCPEA included:

- On January 2, 2022, an airstrike hit a school in the Sawad Asr area of Maain district, Sana'a, according to the Civilian Impact Monitoring Project (CIMP).²⁵
- Artillery shells struck Al Huda School in Maqbanah district, Taizz governorate, on January 19, 2022, killing one student and injuring six others, as reported by CIMP and *Al Masdar*.²⁶
- On February 19, 2022, a drone equipped with explosives hit Al Wahdah School in Hareb district, Mareb governorate, killing three students, according to *Arab News*, *Khabar Agency*, and ACLED.²⁷
- Unidentified gunmen raided Salah Ad Din School in Salh district, Taizz governorate, in August and September 2022, as reported by ACLED and news outlet *Al Masdar*.²⁸
- On October 26, 2022, a Houthi-made explosive device was found within 50 meters of Al-Kifah School in Hays district, Taizz governorate, according to the Panel of Experts on Yemen. A non-governmental organization safely disposed of the device. The name of the location was not detailed in the report.²⁹
- On December 28, 2022, a grenade was thrown into a school in the Musayk neighborhood of Sana'a, causing damage to the building but no casualties, according to CIMP.³⁰

In 2023, GCPEA collected at least 26 reports of attacks on schools.³¹ Separately, the UN reported 20 attacks on schools.³² A human rights organization also reported 144 attacks on schools and incidents of military use of schools, perpetrated primarily by the Houthis, followed by the IRG, STC, and Al-Qaeda in the Arabian Peninsula.³³ However, the UN count and rights organization-reported incidents were not included in the total to

avoid double counting, and since it was unclear how many incidents were attacks on schools, rather than military use, in the latter case. Examples of incidents collected by GCPEA included:

- On March 19, 2023, an explosive device was reportedly dropped from a drone on An Nur School in Ar Rawn village, Al Hudaydah governorate.³⁴
- Parties to conflict reportedly clashed near Muhammad Ali Uthman School in the Wadi al Qadhi area of Taizz city and governorate on March 20, 2023, according to Yemen Data Project as cited in ACLED.³⁵
- On April 21, 2023, shellfire struck a school in Hays district, Al Hudaydah governorate, injuring a boy, as reported by CIMP. GCPEA could not determine whether the child was a student at the school.³⁶
- On May 28, 2023, parties to the conflict reportedly clashed near Arwa School in Ataq city, Shabwa governorate.³⁷
- On November 1, 2023, a drone strike hit near a school in Qa'atabah district, Ad Dali, governorate, killing one boy student and injuring at least eight others, according to CIMP and ACLED.³⁸

ATTACKS ON SCHOOL STUDENTS, TEACHERS, AND OTHER EDUCATION PERSONNEL

During the 2022-2023 reporting period, GCPEA collected 26 reported incidents of attacks on school students, teachers, or other education personnel. These incidents involved the killing, abduction, or injury of over 25 school students and personnel. Such attacks increased as compared to the previous reporting period, when at least seven and six incidents were collected in 2021 and 2020 respectively.³⁹

In 2022, GCPEA identified eight reports of attacks on school students and staff.⁴⁰ For example:

- Gunmen allegedly shot at a school vehicle taking students to classes on August 23, 2022, in Ibb city and governorate, as reported by international media outlet *Al Masdar*.⁴¹
- On October 10, 2022, an alleged armed group attacked several teachers in front of their students in a school in Khanabah village, Ibb governorate, after the teachers declined to participate in celebrations organized by the group, as reported by news outlet *Al Maqea Post*.⁴²
- Save the Children reported that, on October 29, 2022, a shell struck an alley in Taizz city and governorate while three students were on their way home from school. The explosion caused two of the children to lose legs while the third child was hit by shrapnel in his stomach, arm, and leg.⁴³
- In late December 2022, the principal of Ar Rawn School was reportedly abducted in Kusmah district, Raymah governorate, after the administration refused to incorporate a Houthi curriculum.⁴⁴

GCPEA collected 18 reported attacks on school students and staff in 2023.⁴⁵ Abductions and detentions were the most common forms of attack, while others involved threats, small arms fire, or the use of explosive weapons. For instance:

- On January 7, 2023, two girl students were reportedly abducted from Naimah School in Naimah village, Lahj governorate. The principal was also injured for attempting to stop the abduction.⁴⁶
- A drone reportedly dropped an explosive device on a road in Uzlat al Majanih region, Ad Dali governorate,

on February 14, 2023, killing one student and injuring two others while they were on their way to school.⁴⁷

- Several teachers were allegedly detained by IRG-affiliate forces in Jajd al Bard school in Al Maqatirah district, Lahj governorate, as reported by Yemen Data Project and ACLED.⁴⁸
- On October 8, 2023, the leader of a teachers’ union was abducted from his home in Sana’a after the union made demands for the payment of teachers and other public employees, as reported by international media outlet *Arab News*.⁴⁹
- On October 19, 2023, a student was reportedly injured by crossfire on his way home from school in Ibb city and governorate. The day before, a teacher was hit by a bullet and injured after leaving a different school south of the same city.⁵⁰

MILITARY USE OF SCHOOLS AND UNIVERSITIES

In the 2022-2023 reporting period, GCPEA identified at least 99 incidents of schools used for military purposes. In comparison, Education under Attack 2022, which covered 2020 and 2021, included at least 49 cases of military use.⁵¹

In 2022, the UN verified the military use of 67 schools, perpetrated by the parties to the conflict including the Houthis and the Yemen Armed Forces.⁵² Separately, a human rights organization reported 121 cases of schools used for military purposes between September 2021 and August 2022.⁵³ In addition, the same organization documented 20 incidents of military use perpetrated by the Houthis during the truce in fighting between April 2 and October 2, 2022, in governorates including Taizz, Raymah, Ibb, Amran, and Sa’ada.⁵⁴ However, these counts were not included in the total number of military use incidents for this reporting period, since it was unclear how many occurred in 2022, rather than 2021, in the first instance, and because some incidents may have overlapped with the UN count.

In 2023, the UN reported the military use of 32 schools.⁵⁵ Separately, GCPEA identified approximately seven individual reports of military use that year;⁵⁶ these reports were not included in the total since they may have overlapped with the UN count. For instance:

- In early April 2023, a school was allegedly used as a detention center in Wadi al Hasin region, Taizz governorate.⁵⁷
- Around September 2023, two schools were reportedly closed and occupied in Hubaysh Junction area and Al Ma’ayen town in Ibb governorate.⁵⁸
- In late 2023, a military checkpoint was established near a girls’ school in Al Akisha district, Taizz governorate, as reported by local media outlets *Yemeni Education News Network* and *Al Ayyam*.⁵⁹
- In late 2023, several schools in Hajjah and Al Hudaydah governorates were allegedly turned into military training centers.⁶⁰

CHILD RECRUITMENT AT, OR ON THE WAY TO OR FROM, SCHOOL

During the 2022-2023 reporting period, GCPEA identified at least three reports of child recruitment at school. Education under Attack 2022 included several reports detailing child recruitment or indoctrination at schools or along school routes.⁶¹

In mid-January 2022, two boy students, aged ten and 12, were recruited from their school in Sana’a for use as fighters, as reported by ACLED and local news outlet Al Masdar.⁶² In addition, the UN reported that Houthi members recruited children by threatening their teachers, in a report covering December 2021 to March 2022.⁶³

In late 2023, students were reportedly recruited from secondary schools in Hajjah and Al Hudaydah governorates, according to local media outlet Al Mashhad Al Yemeni.⁶⁴

SEXUAL VIOLENCE AT, OR ON THE WAY TO OR FROM, SCHOOL AND UNIVERSITY

GCPEA collected one report of sexual violence at, or en route to, school and university during the 2022-2023 reporting period. In December 2022, a member of an alleged armed party abducted a girl student while she returned home from school in Sana’a with the purpose of forcing her to marry him, as reported by ACLED and news outlets Mareb Press and Tihama 24.⁶⁵

ATTACKS ON HIGHER EDUCATION

During the 2022-2023 reporting period, GCPEA identified 18 incidents of attacks on higher education. Of these, more than half were attacks on higher education facilities and the remainder included attacks on higher education students or staff. Reported attacks on higher education appear to have increased slightly in 2022 as compared to 2021, when GCPEA collected six such reports. However, the number of identified attacks declined compared to 2020, when 18 such attacks were identified.⁶⁶

In 2022, GCPEA collected ten reports of attacks on higher education.⁶⁷ The attacks on university facilities primarily involved the use of explosive weapons, while attacks on higher education students or staff included abduction and protest repression. For example:

- On January 15, 2022, an airstrike hit a vocational institute in Al-Sawma’ah district, Bayda governorate, according to the Yemen Data Project and CIMP.⁶⁸
- On January 20, 2022, Houthi forces beat and arrested students during an on-campus demonstration at Sana’a University in Sana’a, as reported by Scholars at Risk and news outlet *Al Arabiya*.⁶⁹
- On May 31, 2022, artillery shells struck the College of Literature in Taizz city and governorate, injuring one female student, according to local news outlet *Yeni Yemen* and ACLED.⁷⁰
- On June 27, 2022, Houthi forces entered the Faculty of Arts at Dhamar University, Dhamar city and gov-

ernorate, assaulting personnel and damaging the university, as reported by Scholars at Risk and *Sahafaty* news outlet.⁷¹

- On December 8, 2022, members of an alleged armed party stormed a dormitory and reportedly abducted two students from the College of Oils and Minerals in Ataq city, Shabwa governorate.⁷²

In 2023, GCPEA collected eight reports of attacks on higher education.⁷³ For instance:

- Clashes between alleged armed parties reportedly broke out near Taizz University in Taizz city and governorate on January 22, 2023.⁷⁴
- On April 4, 2023, an improvised explosive device reportedly detonated near National University in Taizz city and governorate.⁷⁵
- On May 24, 2023, a professor was reportedly shot and killed in Juban town, Ad Dali governorate.⁷⁶
- Members of a defense force affiliated with the Southern Transitional Council stormed a student dormitory in Ataq city, Shabwa governorate, where they detained students on August 30, 2023, according to Scholars at Risk and a media report.⁷⁷
- On October 4, 2023, armed men allegedly fired live bullets into the air to disperse students demonstrating at the College of Medicine at Dhamar University in Dhamar city and governorate. The students were reportedly protesting over the murder of a peer, according to media outlet *Yemen Shabab*.⁷⁸

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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8 Ali M Latifi, "'If I am killed, let it be in the name of education.'," *The New Humanitarian*, October 6, 2023.

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15 Wagdy Sawahel, "Universities closed amid armed clashes in the capital," *University World News*, August 16, 2023.

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17 GCPEA, *"It Is Very Painful to Talk About": Impact of Attacks on Education on Women and Girls* (New York: GCPEA, 2019). GCPEA, *"All That I Have Lost": Impact of Attacks on Education for Women and Girls in Kasai Central Province Democratic Republic of Congo* (New York: GCPEA, 2019). GCPEA, *"I Will Never Go Back to School": The Impact of Attacks on Education for Nigerian Women and Girls* (New York: GCPEA, 2018).

18 UNICEF, "UNICEF DRC Humanitarian Situation Report No. 2: 31 July 2023," August 19, 2023, p. 10.

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GLOBAL OVERVIEW

1 A systematic pattern was defined as ten reported attacks on education or military use of educational facilities in 2021 and 2022 combined.

2 GCPEA tracks five categories of attacks on education and military use: Attacks on schools; attacks on school students, teachers, and other education personnel; military use of schools and universities; child recruitment at, or on the way to or from, school; sexual violence at, or on the way to or from, school or university; and attacks on higher education.

3 Israel does not have a country profile in this report because GCPEA did not identify the requisite number of attacks on education within its territory in 2021 and 2022. For more details on country profile criteria, see the Methodology section.

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List of Fragile and Conflict-Affected Situations, specifically to countries listed as in conflict (in some years, the WBG break this category into medium- and high-intensity conflict). If the WBG’s list included the country in question, the country was considered to be in armed conflict; if not on the WBG’s list, then the country was not considered to be in armed conflict.

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